MIT SOLVE 2027 · GLOBAL ECONOMIC PROSPERITY CHALLENGE

# Every question, ready to answer.

Retake, entered under "create pathways to quality employment and economic opportunity". Each question on the form, in order, with what to write, what we already have, and what we must not overclaim.



> **Deadline: Friday 6 November 2026, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India).** Late applications are not accepted, even for technical problems. Aim to submit by Monday 2 November.

BEFORE YOU START

# How to use this workbook. Who fills what, and the rules.

The form has five sections, covered here in the same order. Every question is a card. The chip on each card says what it needs:

**READY** the answer is settled: copy it in. **FACTS NEEDED** only the team knows it: fill it in.

**WRITE** a written answer, in your own words, from the material on the card.

**TEAM LEAD** the team lead does this personally.

> **WRITE IN YOUR OWN WORDS**
>
> Solve says: "We do not recommend using generative AI tools to write your application for you", because such answers read as generic and "can strongly disadvantage your application." Use the material on each card as notes, and write the answer yourself. AI tools may then be used, as Solve suggests, to shorten a draft or check the grammar.

> **Women in India are about half as likely as men to be in paid work. One reason is the everyday decisions made about them at work: who is hired, sent, trusted and promoted. Retake trains and measures those decisions, and Solve's support would take it into workplaces and prove it.**

That is the one idea every answer comes back to. Keep the answers consistent with it.

> **FOUR CLAIMS WE MUST NOT MAKE**
>
> The form's Accuracy and Integrity Agreement says that exaggerating "may lead to the removal of my solution from the Challenge." So, in every answer:
>
> - **No users yet.** No workplace has used Retake. The prototype has been played by the team and in walkthroughs only.
> - **No paying customers yet.** Unless the team has a signed partner, the business model is a plan.
> - **The reading is not validated.** How many decisions a confident reading needs, and how they become one figure, is still being worked out.
> - **Retake shows choices inside the game.** We do not claim it changes who gets hired or promoted. That is what a pilot would test.

SECTION 1 · INSTRUCTIONS

# Three agreements. The team lead reads and ticks them.

## 1 Terms of Service Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

**WHAT IT SAYS**

"I agree to MIT Solve's Terms of Service, the MIT Solve Media Release and License, and the MIT Solve Privacy Policy." Read all three before ticking. The media release covers how Solve may use our name, video and materials.

## 2 Accuracy and Integrity Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

**WHAT IT SAYS**

Fabricating, exaggerating or misrepresenting anything "may lead to the removal of my solution". If AI tools were used in writing, we confirm we have checked that every answer is accurate. This is why the four claims on page 2 matter.

## 3 GenAI Data Processing Consent

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

**WHAT IT SAYS**

Solve may use AI tools to help process and review applications, with steps to keep personal data out of them. Read it, then tick.

### GOOD TO KNOW, FROM SOLVE'S INSTRUCTIONS

- **Applying to Learning too?** Keep every fact identical across both. Here the adult version is the product for workplaces; there it is where the measure is proven before the student version. A third-party listing says one team may enter two challenges and must choose one if both advance: confirm with help@solve.mit.edu.
- **Public answers.** The Solution Profile becomes public on Solve's site if we reach the semi-finals.
- **The team lead travels.** If we are selected as Finalists, the team lead pitches and interviews with judges over Zoom in February. If we are selected as Solvers, the team lead must attend Solver Orientation in Cambridge, MA in April 2027 (Solve gives travel assistance) and the Solve Challenge Finals in New York in September. Start on the US visa early.
- **Saving.** The form saves as you go, and you can skip between sections. Nothing counts until someone clicks Submit Solution.
- **English only.** Every answer and uploaded file must be in English.

SECTION 2 · SOLUTION PROFILE

# Who we are and what Retake is. Public if we reach the semi-finals.

## 4 What is the name of your organization?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER The Equal Lens

## 5 What is the name of your solution?

REQUIRED 30 CHARACTERS READY

ANSWER Retake

WHY It is the name the app already uses. Solve suggests 1 to 4 words and treats the organisation name and the solution name separately.

## 6 Provide a one-line summary or tagline for your solution.

REQUIRED 10 TO 20 WORDS, 150 CHARACTERS WRITE

INCLUDE

- a daily puzzle for managers and teams;
- choices between equally qualified colleagues;
- shows where gender sways who is hired, sent or promoted;
- practice that makes those decisions fairer.

DRAFT

## 7 In what city, town, or region is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER

## 8 In what country is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER India

## 9 What type of organization is your solution team?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

**OPTIONS**

For-profit · Nonprofit · Hybrid · Not registered as any organization · Other, including part of a larger organization

**HOW TO CHOOSE**

If The Equal Lens is registered as a trust, society or Section 8 company, choose **Nonprofit**. If it is not registered yet, choose **Not registered as any organization**. Use the same answer as in the Learning application.

**ANSWER**

## 10 Film your elevator pitch.

OPTIONAL · UP TO 3 MINUTES · DO IT

**WHY DO IT**

Not required, but Solve says a video helps reviewers understand the solution, and suggests showing a demo if there is a product. We have one.

**HOW**

Record a phone playing the demo and talk over it. About **20 seconds** on the problem; **60 seconds** playing one workplace decision, such as who becomes senior loco pilot; then its twin decision and what the pair shows. Close on what a company would see. A separate video from the Learning one, framed for workplaces.

**SETTINGS**

Upload to YouTube or Vimeo as **public or unlisted**, then paste the link.

## 11 What specific problem are you solving?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

The specific problem within the Challenge; its scale where we work and globally; how many people it affects; what causes it.

**MATERIAL**

- **The gap.** Solve's own Challenge page: "women remain 24% less likely than men to participate in the labor force." In India, 41.7% of women aged 15 and over are in the labour force, against 78.8% of men (Periodic Labour Force Survey 2023-24, MoSPI).
- **Part of it is decided inside workplaces.** Who is hired, given the shift or the route, sent on the course, promoted, believed. When science faculty rated identical applications from "John" and "Jennifer", John was judged more competent and hireable and offered a higher salary (Moss-Racusin and colleagues, 2012).
- **The bias is common.** UNDP's 2023 Gender Social Norms Index finds nearly 9 in 10 people worldwide hold at least one bias against women. *Found in secondary reports: confirm in the UNDP report before citing.*
- **Training rarely reaches the decision.** Gender training at work is usually a one-off session counted by attendance, so no one can see whether decisions get fairer. One-off diversity training has weak and short-lived effects (Dobbin and Kalev, 2016). *Team: add an example from a company you know, if you have one.*

**DRAFT**

## 12 What is your solution?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

What it is, what it does, how it works and what technology it uses, in simple terms. About the solution, not the problem. A demo link if relevant.

**MATERIAL**

- **A daily puzzle app** set in five illustrated Indian workplaces and homes: a railway crew lobby, a truck depot, a travelling show, a cricket club and a family home. Three short decisions a day.
- **Each decision is a real kind of workplace call:** who drives the night train, who becomes senior loco pilot, who carries the cash, who captains, who gets the course seat. It shows 3 to 5 people with their records.
- **Two of them have identical records**, one woman and one man. One detail differs, such as the boss calling her "pushy" and him "takes charge". Later, a twin decision puts that detail on the other side, with different people.
- **The reading comes from the pair.** The man both times is a lean towards men; the woman both times is a lean towards women; following the detail both times is no lean. In some twins the detail really matters, such as who holds the licence.
- **What each player gets:** a private reading, a "look again" at the pair, and practice on new cases. Leaderboards reward fair play both ways.
- **What runs today:** a 20-minute starter of five chapters, in Hinglish, Hindi and English, installable on a phone and working offline. *Planned, not built:* an anonymous summary for employers showing which kinds of decision lean.

**DRAFT**

## 13 Who does your solution serve, and in what ways will the solution impact their lives?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

The people whose lives we aim to improve, how they are underserved now, and how the solution meets their needs.

**MATERIAL**

- **The people deciding:** managers, supervisors, recruiters and HR staff in Indian organisations, including transport, logistics, retail, manufacturing and small businesses. Their everyday calls decide who gets work and who moves up.
- **The people decided about:** women at entry level and on the frontline, whose shifts, routes, training and promotions depend on a supervisor's call. Men too: the reading counts a lean either way.
- **How they are underserved:** training rarely touches the decision itself and is rarely measured, so a fair worker can be passed over without anyone noticing a pattern.
- **What changes:** decision-makers notice when a word such as "her family worries" is doing the work; an organisation sees where its decisions lean and can add clear criteria there.
- **Built to be safe at work:** each person's reading stays private; an employer would see only anonymous totals, so no one is judged or penalised by their reading. *A design commitment for the workplace version.*

**DRAFT**

## 14 Would you like to save these answers to a Solution Profile?

READY

**ANSWER**

Save as a New Solution Profile

**WHY**

If the Learning profile is already saved, do not reuse it here as it is: the problem, solution and who-it-serves answers are written differently for workplaces. Save this one separately.

SECTION 3 · YOUR ELIGIBILITY

# Can Solve review us? Yes, at Prototype stage.

## 15 Is technology a core part of your solution?

REQUIRED READY

**ANSWER** Yes, tech is core to our solution.

**WHY** The training and the reading are the app: the paired decisions, the shuffling and the reading cannot run without it.

## 16 Does your solution address an economic opportunity or financial inclusion problem?

REQUIRED READY

**ANSWER** Yes

**WHY** Biased decisions about who is hired, assigned and promoted limit women's access to work and to advancement. That is economic opportunity.

## 17 What is your solution's stage of development?

REQUIRED READY

**ANSWER** Prototype

**WHY** Solve: "an initial working version of a solution that may be in the process of getting initial feedback or testing with users... (Often 0 users)". Concept would not be reviewed at all, and Pilot needs a launch in at least one community. Solve warns that "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection."

## 18 Please share details about why you selected the stage above.

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

What we have built and tested so far. Only what is done, not plans.

**BUILT**

- A playable 20-minute starter with 28 workplace and household decisions across five chapters.
- Five kinds of puzzle playable today (pick one, believe, pick a team, a batting order, and sharing out chores), and six more designed.
- Five illustrated worlds and more than 50 painted characters from across India.
- Three languages: Hinglish, Hindi and English, for frontline as well as office workforces.
- A design system covering every screen.

**TESTED**

- Played through on phones in all three languages with no errors.
- An earlier build passed automated accessibility checks with zero issues across 141 screen visits at six screen sizes. A manual screen-reader check is still to do.
- A check that every hidden pair matches exactly on every number.

**SAY PLAINLY**

No workplace and no one outside the team has used it yet. That is why this is a Prototype.

**DRAFT**

SECTION 4 · SOLUTION & TEAM DETAILS

# Reach, team and contacts. Mostly facts only the team has.

## 19 How many beneficiaries or customers does your solution currently serve?

REQUIRED READY

**ANSWER** None

**WHY** Solve: "The option you select here will not change your chances of being selected... Be honest – exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection." Count only people reached by Retake itself, not by our other programmes.

## 20 Does your solution have a website, app, or social media handle?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

**TO DECIDE** Yes, if we list The Equal Lens website or the demo link. The demo link is open to anyone who has it, so decide first whether to share it.

**LINKS**

## 21 Which dimension of the Challenge does your solution most closely address?

REQUIRED READY

**ANSWER** **Create pathways to quality employment and economic opportunity, particularly for young people and workers excluded from formal labor markets as AI and other technologies reshape entry-level work.**

**WHY** Fairer decisions about who is hired, assigned and promoted open the way into work and up through it for women. The other two dimensions are financial health and housing, which do not fit. Do not claim an AI angle we do not have.

## 22 How are you and your team well-positioned to deliver this solution?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE · FACTS NEEDED

**SOLVE ASKS**

Not credentials. They want the experience, relationships, data and knowledge to deliver, with **specific examples of how we have engaged the people we serve**, how many, and how that input shaped the solution.

**MATERIAL**

- The Equal Lens's work on gender norms through play, and the facilitation experience behind it. *Team: years, sessions, places.*
- Any conversations with employers, HR teams or worker groups, and what they told us about how training is done and measured today. *Team: names and numbers where they can be shared.*
- How their input shaped Retake: for example, decisions modelled on real calls such as shifts, routes, course seats and promotions.
- The team's background in design, research and facilitation. *Team: fill in.*
- The content is written for India: Indian workplaces, a cast from across the country and its faiths, three languages.

**DRAFT**

## 23 In which countries do you currently operate?

READY

**ANSWER**

India

## 24 Which, if any, additional countries will you be operating in within the next year?

FACTS NEEDED

**HOW TO CHOOSE**

Leave it empty unless a partner abroad is actually lined up.

## 25 How many people work on your solution team?

REQUIRED | 100 WORDS | FACTS NEEDED

**GIVE**

Separate numbers for full-time staff, part-time staff, and contractors or other workers. Count volunteers under "other" and say they are volunteers. Same numbers as the Learning application.

**ANSWER**

## 26 How long have you been working on your solution?

REQUIRED | 100 WORDS | FACTS NEEDED

**GIVE**

The years The Equal Lens has worked on gender norms, and that Retake itself has been in development since 2026. *Team: the founding year and the month Retake started.*

**ANSWER**

## 27 Why are you applying to Solve?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

The financial, technical, legal, cultural or market barriers Solve can help with, and how. Solve warns: "If your only goal in applying to Solve is to raise funds, Solve is not the right program for you!"

**MATERIAL**

- **Technical: validation.** Test whether a change in the game predicts fairer real decisions, against a partner company's own hiring and promotion records with consent. We need research partners for this.
- **Market: access to employers.** Introductions to companies and HR networks for a first workplace pilot, and help with pricing and selling to organisations.
- **Legal: privacy and ethics at work.** A design in which no one is judged by their reading, with anonymous totals and consent that meet India's data protection rules.
- **Cultural: content at scale.** Decisions drawn from more sectors and more Indian languages for frontline workforces.

**DRAFT**

## 28 Who is the Team Lead for your solution?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

**WHO**

The head of the organisation, responsible for Retake's direction. Name only, and the same person as in the Learning application. This person pitches to judges over Zoom in February if we are Finalists, and travels to Cambridge, MA in April and New York in September if we are selected.

**NAME**

## 29 Contacts for Solve only (not seen by judges)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

**FILL**

Team lead's email (required), team lead's phone with country code (required), and a backup contact's name, email and phone. If we are Finalists Solve writes to the team lead in early February, with a short deadline to confirm, so give an inbox someone watches. A backup contact makes sure the message is not missed.

## 30 Questions about the team lead and our history (Solve only)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

**THE QUESTIONS**

- Is the Team Lead a resident of the United States? **No**, unless that changes.
- What is the Team Lead's gender? Is the Team Lead transgender? *The team lead answers, or chooses "prefer not to answer".* Solve asks for reporting only; judges never see it.
- Has anyone from our organisation been selected as a Solver before? **No**, unless someone has. Only if yes, a further question asks what makes this solution different from the earlier one.
- Is the solution part of another entrepreneurship network (incubator, accelerator, fellowship)? *Team: check.*
- Did you take the MITx course "Business and Impact Planning for Social Enterprises"? Answer truthfully; it does not affect selection.
- Did you hear about Solve through a network or mailing list? *Team: check.*

# Why it is new, why it will work, and how it pays for itself.

## 31 What makes your solution innovative?

300 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

How it approaches the problem in a new or much improved way; how it differs from others; how it could change the field.

**MATERIAL**

- **It works on the decision, not on attitudes.** Most gender training is a one-off talk, and its effects are weak and fade (Dobbin and Kalev, 2016). Implicit-bias tests have a weak link to what people do (Forscher and colleagues, 2019).
- **It measures decisions,** using the logic of the identical-CV studies, inside a game people choose to play.
- **It reads a lean either way,** towards men or towards women, and separates being swayed by a word from being swayed by gender. No one is accused, and favouring women counts as much as favouring men.
- **A daily habit, not a workshop:** three short decisions a day, with leaderboards that reward fair play.
- **Made for Indian workplaces,** including frontline ones: Indian settings, names and languages, from Hinglish to Hindi, on a phone, offline.
- **For the field:** a way for organisations to see whether their gender training changes decisions, which attendance counts cannot show.

**DRAFT**

## 32 Describe in simple terms how and why you expect your solution to have an impact on the problem.

300 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

Our theory of change: how activities lead to outputs and to short- and long-term outcomes, with evidence for each link (research, interviews, our own data).

**MATERIAL**

- **Activities:** managers and employees play three short decisions a day; each gets a private reading and a "look again" at the pair they treated differently; the organisation sees anonymous totals.
- **Outputs:** a private reading per person; a map of which kinds of decision lean, such as promotions as against shift assignments.
- **Short-term outcomes:** decision-makers notice when a word or detail is doing the work; HR adds clear criteria where the organisation leans.
- **Long-term outcomes:** fairer hiring, assignment and promotion; more women entering work and moving up.
- **Evidence for the links:** identical-application studies show bias acts in decisions (Moss-Racusin 2012); clear criteria and structured decisions reduce bias (Bohnet, *What Works*, 2016); noticing and practice can reduce bias (Devine and colleagues, 2012).
- **The honest gap:** whether a change inside the game carries into real decisions is what the pilot will measure, against a partner's own records.

**DRAFT**

## 33 Describe your solution's tech stack and how you know that it works.

300 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

The technology, and proof that it works. For new technology, a paper or other public evidence.

**MATERIAL**

- **The app:** a web app that installs on a phone and works offline (a Progressive Web App), built in React and TypeScript. The puzzles are data, so new content needs no new code. Three languages switch on every screen.
- **The reading:** every decision has a twin built to the same rules. An automated check refuses any set where the pair's numbers differ, where a person repeats, or where a hard fact is said of a name that marks a community.
- **The art:** illustrations are made with an open image model run on our own computer, then reviewed and corrected by hand. Players never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading.
- **How we know it works:** the playable demo (the video shows it), automated accessibility and layout checks, and written content rules that every puzzle must pass.
- **Not yet built or proven:** the anonymous employer summary, and that the reading is a valid measure. Say so, and that both come first in the funded work.

**DRAFT**

## 34 Please select the technologies currently used in your solution.

READY

**ANSWER**

Software and Mobile Applications · Behavioral Technology

**TO DECIDE**

Generative AI makes the illustrations only. Tick it only if the team wants to declare that; either way, say it in question 33. Answer the same way as in the Learning application.

## 35 What is your business model?

300 WORDS · WRITE

**SOLVE ASKS**

How we create value for the people we serve: key customers and beneficiaries, what we give them, how, and why they want it.

**MATERIAL**

- **Customers:** companies and organisations that already spend time on gender training. India's POSH Act requires employers to hold regular awareness programmes, so the time and budget exist. *Check the Act's wording before citing.*
- **What they get:** gender-fair decision practice their people come back to, and an anonymous picture of where their decisions lean, which a one-off session cannot give.
- **Beneficiaries:** the women and men whose hiring, shifts and promotions depend on those decisions.
- **Access:** a subscription per employee for companies; free for NGOs and small employers through CSR sponsorship.
- **Mission link:** income from workplaces funds the free school version for students.

**DRAFT**

## 36 Do you primarily provide products or services directly to individuals, to other organizations, or to the government?

READY

**ANSWER**

Organizations (B2B)

**WHY**

Employers are the customers; their people are the players.

## 37 What is your plan for becoming financially sustainable, and what evidence can you provide that this plan has been successful?

300 WORDS | WRITE | FACTS NEEDED

**SOLVE ASKS**

How money comes in (grants, donations, sales, government contracts, investment) and evidence it has worked so far: grants received, revenue, funder names and amounts where they can be shared.

**MATERIAL**

- **Company subscriptions** as the main income, after a first paid pilot.
- **CSR funds:** India's Companies Act requires large companies to spend 2% of their profits on social causes, which can sponsor free use by NGOs and small employers.
- **Grants** for the validation research.
- **Evidence to date.** *Team: grants received, any company conversations or letters of interest, with names and amounts if they can be shared. If there are none yet, say what is in progress, honestly.*

**DRAFT**

SECTION 6 · SUBMIT

# Last checks. Then the team lead submits.

| Check | Done |
|---|---|
| Every required question answered, in English, within its limit | |
| The four claims on page 2 hold in every answer: no users, no paying customers, reading not validated, no claim about real hiring or promotion | |
| Every shared fact matches the Learning application, if both are submitted | |
| The UNDP figure and the POSH Act wording confirmed in their originals, or removed | |
| Our own numbers (team, sessions, funding, company conversations) checked by the person who knows them | |
| The video is public or unlisted, and the link opens when signed out | |
| Submit Solution clicked by Monday 2 November; the final deadline is Friday 6 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern | |

## SOURCES · CHECKED 22 OCTOBER 2026


1. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Economic Prosperity Challenge** (solve.mit.edu/challenges/2027-global-economic-prosperity-challenge): the questions, dimensions, stage definitions, deadline, and "women remain 24% less likely than men to participate in the labor force".
2. **MoSPI, Periodic Labour Force Survey annual report, July 2023 to June 2024** (press note, September 2024): labour force participation at 15 and over, women 41.7%, men 78.8%.
3. **UNDP, 2023 Gender Social Norms Index:** nearly 9 in 10 people hold at least one bias against women. Found in secondary summaries; confirm in the UNDP report before citing.
4. **Moss-Racusin and colleagues (2012),** "Science faculty's subtle gender biases favor male students", PNAS.
5. **Dobbin and Kalev (2016),** "Why Diversity Programs Fail", Harvard Business Review.
6. **Forscher and colleagues (2019),** "A meta-analysis of procedures to change implicit measures", Journal of Personality and Social Psychology.
7. **Bohnet (2016),** *What Works: Gender Equality by Design*, Harvard University Press.
8. **Devine and colleagues (2012),** "Long-term reduction in implicit race bias: a prejudice habit-breaking intervention", Journal of Experimental Social Psychology.


**Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.**